THE WORLD OF PLASTIC FANTASTIC

From mommy makeovers to the ever-popular rhinoplasty, some emerging treatments in plastic surgery

LUNCHTIME BOTOX
Advanced botox injectables where recovery time can be as little as one hour
Cost: Rs 7,000 to Rs 30,000

HYALURONIC ACID FILLERS
Injectable gels to the face that restore volume and add body to the face
Cost: Rs 15,000 to Rs 30,000

MOMMY MAKEOVERS
A set of minimally invasive procedures to restore a woman's body post giving birth. This can include breast, tummy, hip reshaping and facials
Cost: Starts at Rs 40,000

HYBRID FACELIFTS
A combination of different facelifts done in one session alone
Cost: Starts at Rs 30,000



HIGH-DEFINITION LIPOSUCTION
A surgical procedure that removes fat to enhance muscle definition and contours. It allows surgeons to create abs, toned thighs and biceps
Cost: Starts at Rs 2 lakh; six-pack abs start at Rs 4 lakh

PERMANENT FACE THREADS
A non-surgical procedure that can lift and contour sagging skin on the face and neck. They are made from biocompatible materials like silicone or polylactic acid
Cost: Rs 10,000 to Rs 1.5 lakh, depending on area and severity

MINIMALLY INVASIVE RHINOPLASTY
Uses minimal incisions to reshape the nose
Cost: Rs 25,000 to Rs 1 lakh

LASER-GUIDED FACIALS
For subtle facial treatments, from easing wrinkles and fine lines to improving skin tone, texture, and tautness
Cost: Rs 20,000 to Rs 1.5 lakh

AROUND A MILLION INDIANS ARE DIAGNOSED WITH BODY DYSMORPHIC DISORDER (BDD) ANNUALLY. THE RISK OF BDD PATIENTS GETTING ADDICTED TO PLASTIC SURGERY MAKES IT CRUCIAL FOR THE ENFORCEMENT OF AN ETHICAL CODE OF CONDUCT

over a million aesthetic procedures in a year by plastic surgeons in India are non-surgical. According to business consulting firm Grand View Research, the Indian non-invasive aesthetic (to improve appearances, as opposed to reconstructive plastic surgery) treatment market generated revenue of Rs 16,400 crore in 2023 and is expected to touch more than Rs 56,000 crore by 2030. With nose jobs being the most popular out of all procedures, just the non-surgical rhinoplasty market in India is projected to touch Rs 277 crore by 2030.

Globally, the march of non-surgical procedures has quickened—ISAPS reported that they outnumbered surgical ones in 2020. "Most surgeries can be pain-free today due to better anaesthesia and post-surgical care. Many clients prefer secrecy, and procedures today will ensure that," says Telang. According to the ISAPS survey, India ranks second and third in rhinoplasty and liposuction surgeries, respectively, and seventh in surgical and nonsurgical aesthetic procedures. It ranks second in nonsurgical facial rejuvenation procedures.

THE MARCH OF NEW TECHNOLOGIES

Today, top surgeons use equipment that can evaluate surrounding tissues in real-time at a resolution that can see particles as small as 7 microns (the size of a red blood cell). There are cameras that can also process real-time blood loss estimation. Cameras have haptic sensors, that measure the force needed by equipment, as well as a tracker that allows the lens to move automatically to where a surgeon looks. Some surgeons use robotic-assisted surgery that allows 95 per cent precision, VR simulations for pre-operative planning and 3D printers which can make bespoke scaffolds (a porous framework for the patient's own tissue to grow into) and implants.

"Tech has played a vital part in making aesthetic surgery safer and more acceptable to patients. High quality implants have given women the confidence to go ahead with procedures that were frowned upon previously. Technology such as VASER (a machine that uses ultrasound waves to remove fat) has made liposuction safe and we are creating natural six